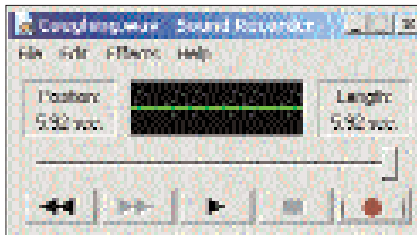


3 Thou shalt lie

The ultimate work-shirk is not even coming in to office. Why waste all that time travelling, when you can stay at home? The problem is that bosses never believe your lame excuses, since they are well-versed with every excuse in the book. What you need to do is convince them over the phone that you're telling the truth.

If you want to call in sick, the fake cough that you emit at a strategic pre-planned point in your conversation with the boss, just never seems to come out right. So, the next time you get a sore throat, record your coughing spasms on your PC as a WAV file. Now, when you call in sick, play the file and sound like you're dying.

Of course, this means that you're



Recording background noises to back you up on your excuses may help you keep your job

only limited by your imagination. Just make sure you label your WAV files correctly. You don't want a background of the sounds of the Amazon jungles or a Delhi traffic jam starting to play when you're pretending to be sick.

2 Don't do that, or you'll go blind

One really neat trick you can try is to loosen all the peripherals and card in your cabinet. When no one's looking, shut down your PC, open up the cabinet, and remove all the screws for the peripherals. Get rid of the evidence: clean up the screws lying about. Now, loosen the cards a bit, and start your computer, as a test to make sure it still works. If the computer boots properly, carefully close the cabinet and get back to work.

Now, give your cabinet a little kick just when you're showing a colleague something work related. He or she will be your witness. Chances are that your loosened cards will fall out, and cause your OS to hang. Even your display might show some really weird colours, or switch off altogether. Now,

you can spend an hour (or even two) "fixing" your computer!

1 Just bite that apple

Whenever possible, try and grab all the fun work—as the saying goes, "Find a job you like, and you'll never work a day of your life!" Try and get a job as a reviewer for *SKOAR!*, the gaming magazine, or convince your editor to let you write an article called 'Be a Smart@ss @ Work'. You can hold meetings, have brainstorming sessions, go around asking your bosses all sorts of uncomfortable questions, and even goof off a bit and say it's "research!"

If you aren't afraid to share your shirking secrets, write to us at shirkers@thinkdigit.com, and give us a few tips. In the end, remember that your boss was probably doing the same things once, and may be wise to your tactics.

And remember, your boss may be sitting in his or her cabin reading this article, right now! However, since sloth has always been the greatest inspiration for creativity, we're sure you'll keep inventing.

Happy goofing off!

ROBERT SOVEREIGN-SMITH
robert_smith@thinkdigit.com

1/2 page H AD